HONG (IVY) ZHAN

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction and social computing, focusing on trust in generative AI, cross-platform information evaluation, and the design and evaluation of user-centered systems.

EDUCATION

University of York, York, UK 2022 – 2024
MSc in Social Media and Management, with Merit
Selected coursework: Research Design; Understanding Social Media; Social Media, Data & Society.

Wuchang University of Technology, Wuhan, China 2017 – 2021
BEng in Computer Science and Technology
Selected coursework: Software Modeling; Software Testing; Web Front-End Development.

MANUSCRIPTS

Zhan, H. (2026). Beyond the Aggregate: Trust and Distrust in Generative AI Across Technical Reddit Communities and Time. *Under review at Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW).* Sole author.
Preprint: SSRN | Data & code: Zenodo · GitHub

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Trust and Distrust in Technical Reddit Communities
Sole-author research Feb 2026 – Oct 2026

- Found close pooled shares of *Neither* (neither trust nor distrust; 41.7%) and *Trust* (40.0%), with different community orderings: Trust led in r/ChatGPTCoding and r/programming; Neither led in r/webdev, r/GitHub, and r/compsci.
- Compared five technical Reddit communities across half-years using Python and R, analyzing 8,519 classification records and 4,964 dimension records separately.
- Adapted the analysis when source-study fields were unavailable, documenting the replacement measure and limiting conclusions to sampled discourse rather than individual attitudes or AI use.
- Highlighted the need to report pooled AI-trust discourse summaries alongside community- and time-specific views.

Cross-Platform Social Media Use and Information Practices
MSc dissertation research | University of York Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

- Designed and conducted 15 semi-structured interviews (approximately 60 minutes each) about cross-platform social media use and cultural adaptation among Chinese students in the UK.
- Transcribed interviews and coded them thematically in NVivo; analyzed social media posts to examine participation and information evaluation.
- Identified platform-specific communication, language barriers to participation, and cross-platform credibility checking amid perceived media differences.

SELECTED PROJECT

Recruitment Management System
BEng Graduation Thesis (Design) | Wuchang University of Technology Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Investigated recruitment workflows and translated user needs into requirements, interaction flows, and prototypes.
- Implemented job posting, application tracking, and candidate management in Spring Boot and MySQL.
- Evaluated recruitment workflows through think-aloud usability testing with 8 participants; used findings to guide interface revisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Analyst | TikTok Shop, London, UK Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

- Analyzed UK e-commerce KPIs across merchant growth, product operations, and content-driven sales; supported business reviews and cross-functional operational improvements.

Founder & Operations Manager | Zero Point HR, Wuhan, China Oct 2017 – Sep 2022

- Built a recruitment operations platform coordinating approximately 30 staff and matching job seekers with employers.
- Designed candidate-screening, shift-scheduling, and placement-tracking workflows supporting 3,000+ full-time placements and 100,000+ part-time shifts.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Tech Volunteer | BetaNYC, New York, USA Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Supported civic-tech workshops with NYC public datasets and accessible visualizations; engaged residents on barriers to accessing government information.

Data Volunteer | DataKind, London, UK Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Cleaned and analyzed nonprofit service data with Python/pandas in a DataDive; prepared visualizations and a stakeholder briefing to inform program decisions.

International Student Buddy | University of York, York, UK Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Mentored international students transitioning to university life, providing practical guidance and connecting them with campus resources and student communities.

RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

User research: Research design, semi-structured interviews, thematic analysis, think-aloud usability testing, NVivo.

Design & prototyping: Requirements analysis, interaction design, Figma, web development, Spring Boot, MySQL.

Computational methods: Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, descriptive statistics, data validation and provenance.

Research workflow: Git/GitHub, LaTeX, reproducible analysis.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent); Chinese (native).

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Prof. David Beer, Department of Sociology, University of York, Webpage.
Dr Bob Townley, School for Business and Society, University of York, Webpage.
James Lamont, FHEA, Department of Education, University of York, Webpage.